上海交通大學
SHANGHAI JIAO TONG UNIVERSITY

TC3000J
Technical Communication

Professional Correspondence

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Official Letters

Features of a Letter

1) Dürrröhrsdorf, 23rd January 2024

2) Dr. Caroline Meyer
Mittelstraße 90
01833 Dürrrohrsdorf-Dittersbach, Germany

3) Mr. Müller
Institute of Physics – Julius-Maximilians-Universität Würzbug
Senderring 2, 97070 Würzburg

4) **Subject:**

5) Dear Mr. Müller,

6)

7) Best Regards,

8) _____
Dr. Caroline Meyer

1) Date:	The date of writing
2) Sender:	With address
3) Addressee:	Recipient with address
4) Subject line:	Detailed, precise, specific
5) Greeting line:	Ideally personalized
6) Content:	Well-organized into coherent paragraphs
7) Closing line:	Depends on personal standing
8) Signature:	The actual, hand-written signature

Characteristics of a Good Correspondence

Subject indicates content of message

Opens with friendly greeting or thank you

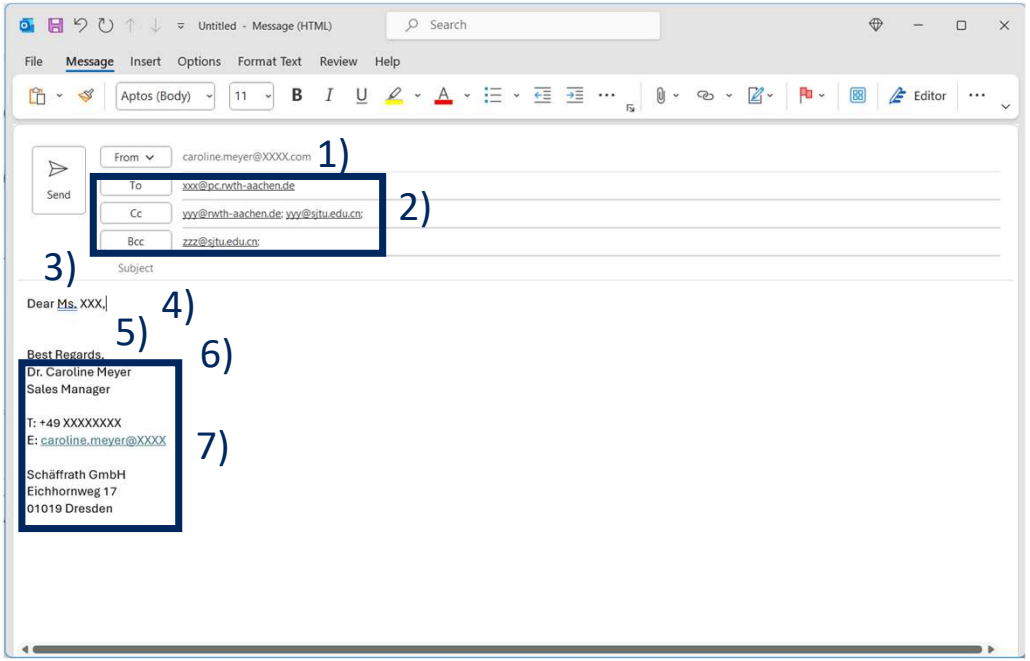
Each paragraph has one central focus

Closes with a concrete request or action statement

Has a professional tone and is careful about being too humorous

Emails at Work

Features of an Email



1) Sender:	Pay attention if you have multiple accounts
2) Addressee:	Recipient

- Carbon copy; every addressee can see this
- Blind carbon copy; will not be visible by recipients

3) Subject line:	Detailed, precise, specific
4) Greeting line:	Ideally personalized
5) Content:	Well-organized into coherent paragraphs
6) Closing line:	Depends on personal standing
7) Signature:	Position and institution, when appropriate
8) Attachments:	Don’t forget to attach them!

Subject

Poor	Better
Trade Show	Need you to showcase two items at Analytica next month
Staff Meeting	Staff meeting rescheduled for May 12
Important!	Please respond to job satisfaction survey
Parking Permits	New employee parking permits available from HR
Help needed / Question	VE300 homework question

Write a clear, specific subject line

Guffey & Loewy (2016)

Greeting Line

Use a respectful greeting! It also confirms whom the message is meant for.

Poor: <nothing at all!>; “Hey”; “Prof. Donald”

Better: “Dear Dr. Wang”; “Dear Prof. Müller”

Pay attention to cultural proclivities and naming schemes!

- E.g., Germans use the surname unless they know each other well

Don’t mix titles and first names! That is extremely disrespectful!

Drafting an Email

Poor

hey, i didn’t understand the lecture this week. I’m having a really hard time grasping the concepts.

Drafting an Email

Introduction

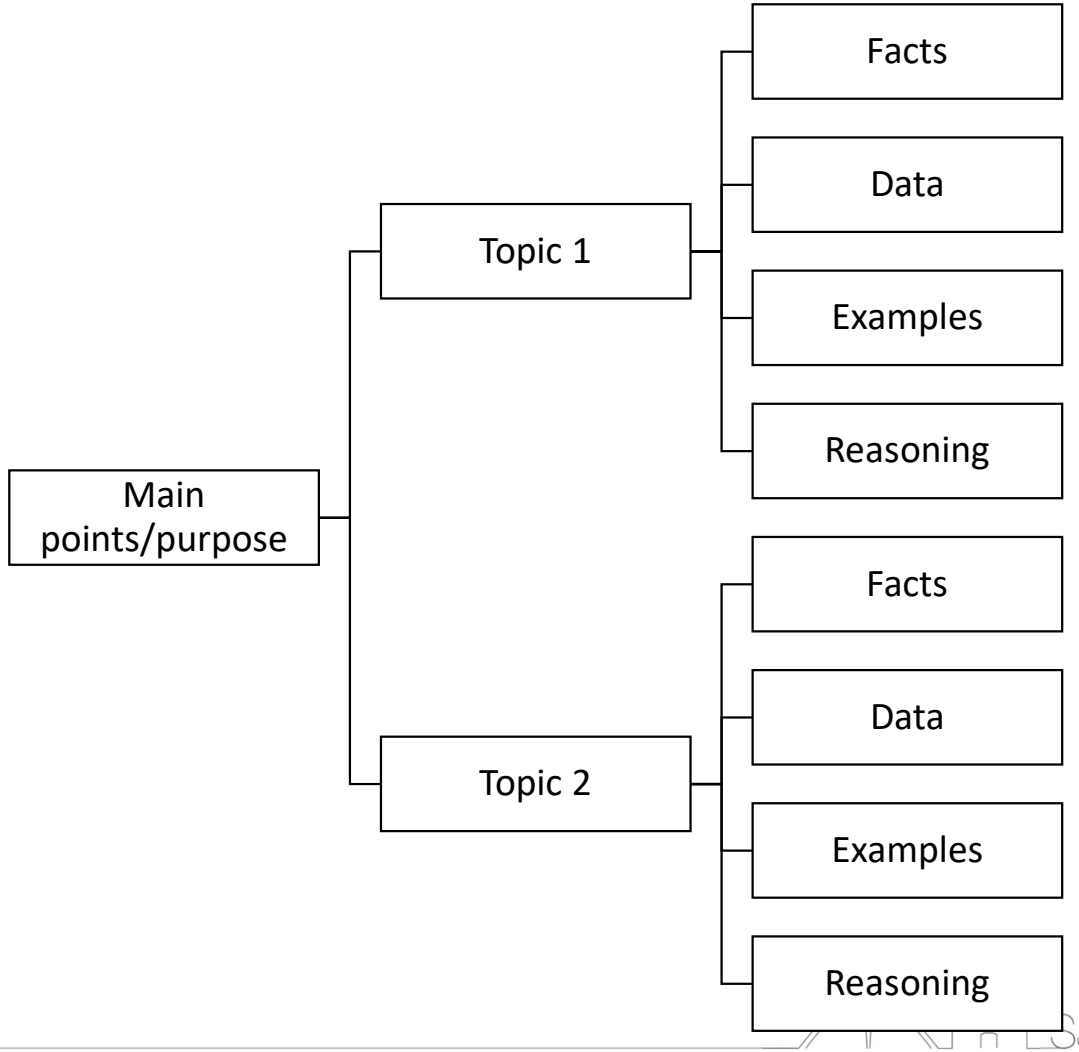
- Subject
- Purpose
- Main point(s)
- Background information
- Importance of the subject

Body

- One topic per paragraph

Conclusion

- Thanking reader
- Restating main point
- Next steps



Email Content

BLUF principle

Put the **b**ottom **l**ine **u**p **f**ront:

State the email purpose within the first two lines.

What is Wrong Here?

Sloppy format: No space after period

Disrespectful mode of address

Not personalized: Sent to all recipients, whether they responded or not, a form of disrespect

Sloppy format: Unnecessary bold and underlined font

Invitation to Questionnaire on the Teaching Input of Inter 1 封邮

发件人: 2022年5月16日 下午 12:09

收件人: "nathaniel murray" <nathaniel.murray@sjtu.edu.cn>

Dear Prof.Nathaniel,

Hope this email finds you well. I am a master's student at the (Student ID: Email: . This email is intended to invite you to fill in the questionnaire on "the Teaching Input of International Faculty in China", and share your personal experience in **teaching** at Chinese universities.

If you have already filled out the questionnaire, please allow me to express my sincere thanks to you for your participation, and please ignore the following content. (We still would be very grateful if you could share this questionnaire with other international faculty in Shanghai.) If you have not completed this questionnaire due to a busy work schedule or other reasons, we sincerely look forward to your participation.